UCX Release Strategy

UMPDE
Software
Engineering

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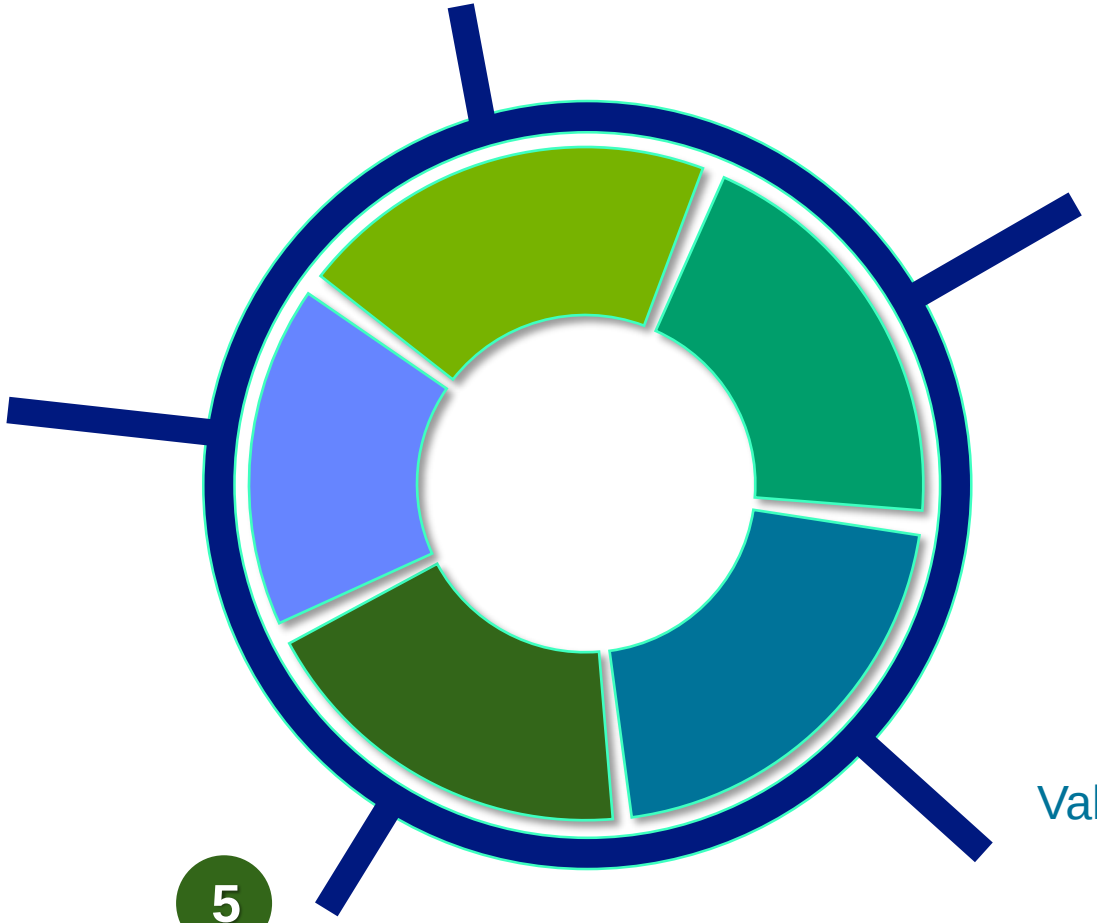
Release Strategy



2
Flexibility in Deployment

3
Zero Bug Prod Deployment

1
Support the Product Vision

4
Value Based Delivery

5
Automation
Automation
Automation

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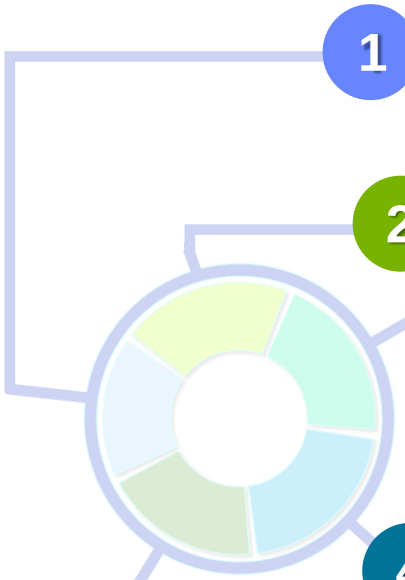
Release Strategy



1	**Support UCX Vision**	• *To provide seamless experience to the clinical team for the informed clinical review* • *Stability, Resiliency, Scalability*
2	**Flexibility in Deployment**	• *Planned releases with flexibility for hot fix releases and occasional special releases* • *Zero downtime*
3	**Zero Bug Deployment**	• *Thoroughly tested code deployment* • *End to End testing / SIT and UAT* • *Regression, Performance & Security Vulnerability Testing*
4	**Value Based Delivery**	• *Features that meet the needs and expectations of the clinical team*
5	**Automation**	• *Fully automated testing – functional, regression*

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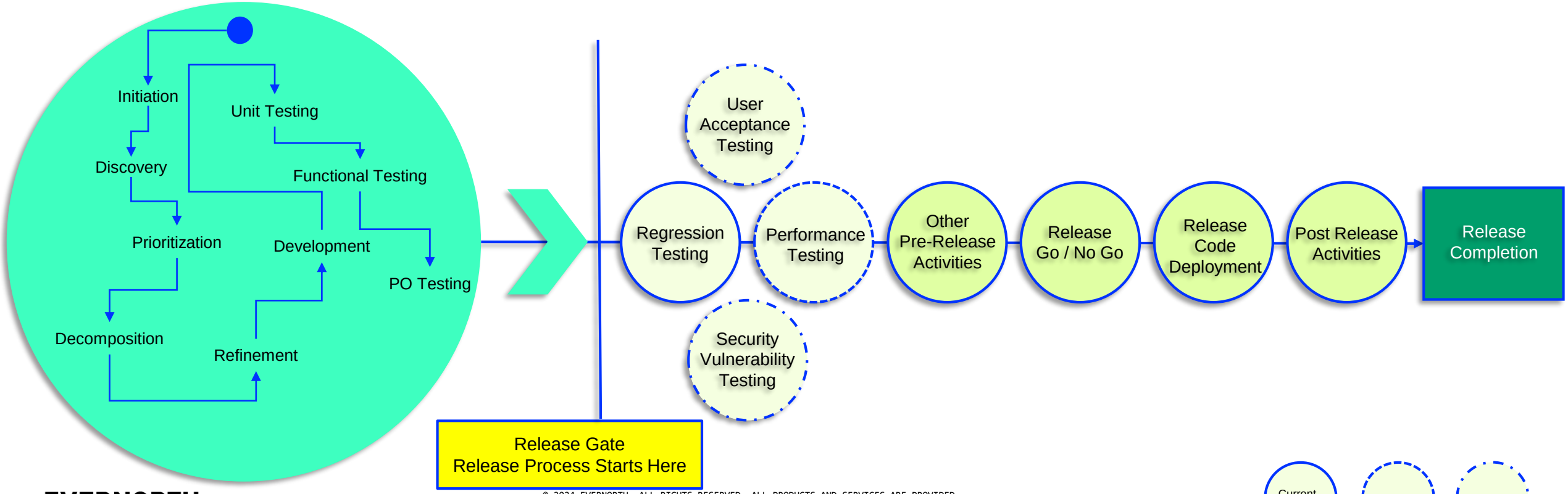
Release Process

UCX Software Release is a series of steps that takes the fully developed and tested source code to the production environment. This is the final stage of the Software Development Life Cycle (SDLC). During this stage, the features are tested extensively to ensure that it is stable and free of production bugs.



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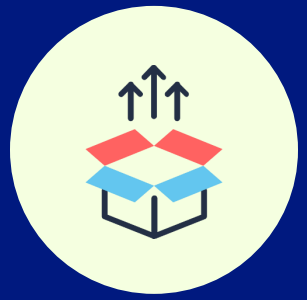
Release Type

Standard Release

- For planned change requests
- Bi-weekly on Wednesday
- Published Calendar
- Established cut-off dates and other dates

Emergency Release

- For hot fixes
- Between two standard releases except 2 days before the release
- Needs SLT & ITSM approvals



Special Release *

- Available when another environment is introduced
- For critical change requests
- Preferably the other Wednesday

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Standard Release

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Standard Release

+ Planned releases
+ Published calendar
+ Clearly defined milestones, cut-off dates and gates
+ Bi-weekly on Wednesdays
+ Alpha and Beta every month (rarely 3rd release Gamma in a month)
+ Year end code freeze for stability
+ Tracking and planning other enterprise wide infrastructure and other product releases
+ Zero downtime

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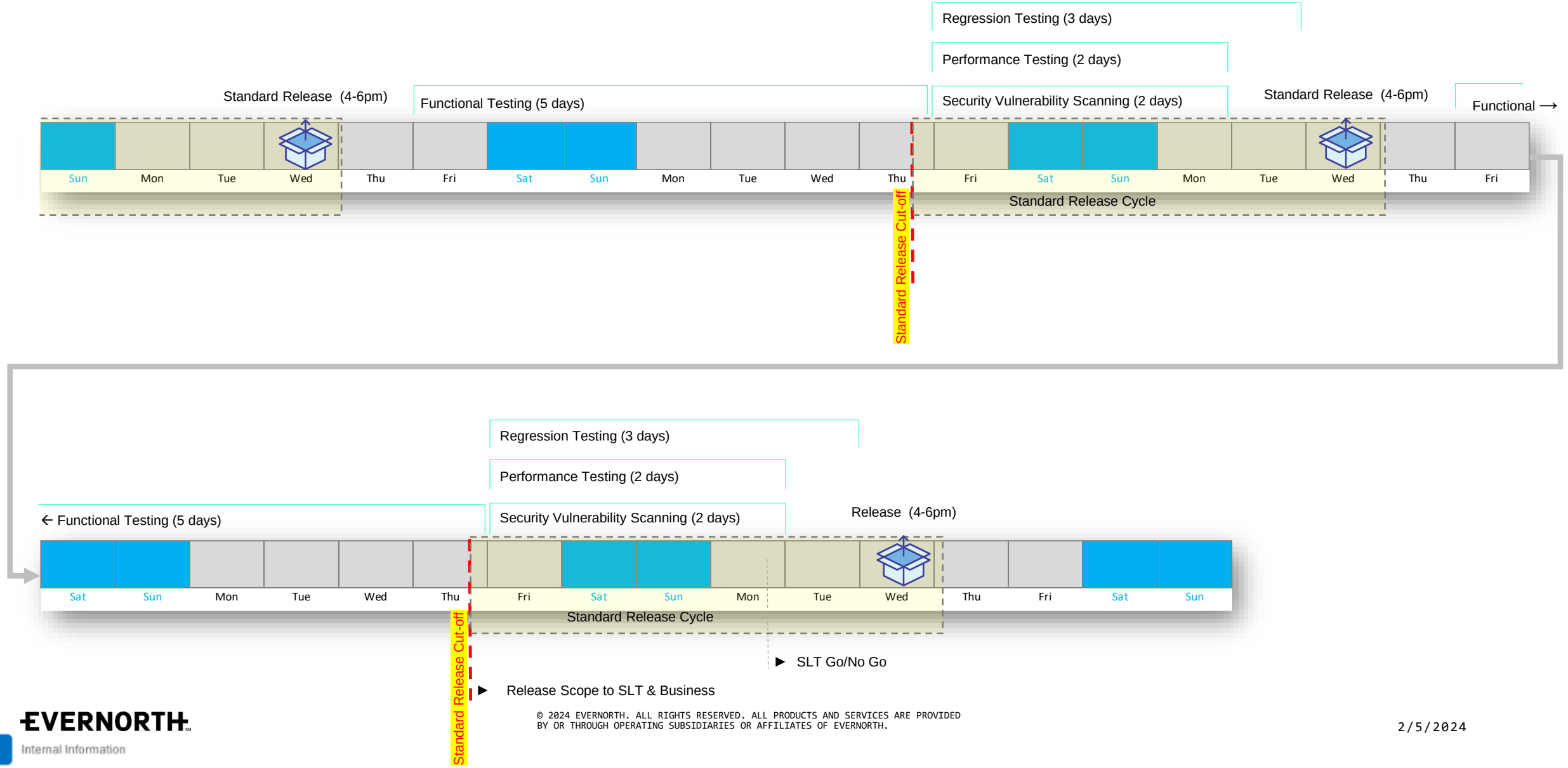
Standard Release – Workflow Overview



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Standard Release – Typical Week 1, 2, 3 and 4

Week	Sun	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat
Week 1		• INTG available for Functional testing	• INTG available for Functional testing	• INTG available for Functional testing • *Sprint close* • PO tags completed features in ADO for targeted release date	• *SM & Eng. complete feature readiness checklist* • INTG available for Functional testing • ***Functional Testing sign-off*** • ***PO Validation sign-off*** • ***INTG freeze @ 5pm CT*** • ***Release CUT-OFF***	• Initiate INTG regression testing • Initiate Performance testing • Initiate Security Vulnerability Scanning	
Week 2		• INTG Regression testing • INTG ***Performance testing & Signoff*** • INTG ***Security Vulnerability Scanning & Signoff***	• INTG ***Regression testing & signoff*** • QA provides COB regression testing results • Deployment Guide ready • *Release Roster ready* • *Post deployment sanity testing plan* • *Post release support plan* • *Release execution webex setup*	**Alpha Release** • Prod release (4-6p CST) • Post deployment sanity testing • Post user End user validation (6p CST)	• ITSE hosts 7-9am CST post-release ***war room*** *(webex)* • ***INTG unfreeze @ 12pm CT*** • INTG available for Functional testing	• INTG available for Functional testing	
Week 3		• INTG available for Functional testing	• INTG available for Functional testing	• INTG available for Functional testing • *Sprint close* • PO tags completed features in ADO for targeted release date	• *SM & Eng. complete feature readiness checklist* • INTG available for Functional testing • ***Functional Testing sign-off*** • ***PO Validation sign-off*** • ***INTG freeze @ 5pm CT*** • ***Release CUT-OFF***	• Initiate INTG regression testing • Initiate Performance testing • Initiate Security Vulnerability Scanning	
Week 4		• INTG Regression testing • INTG ***Performance testing & Signoff*** • INTG ***Security Vulnerability Scanning & Signoff***	• INTG ***Regression testing & signoff*** • QA provides COB regression testing results • Deployment Guide ready • *Release Roster ready* • *Post deployment sanity testing plan* • *Post release support plan* • *Release execution webex setup*	**Beta Release** • Prod release (4-6p CST) • Post deployment sanity testing • Post user End user validation (6p CST)	• ITSE hosts 7-9am CST post-release ***war room*** *(webex)* • ***INTG unfreeze @ 12pm CT*** • INTG available for Functional testing	• INTG available for Functional testing	

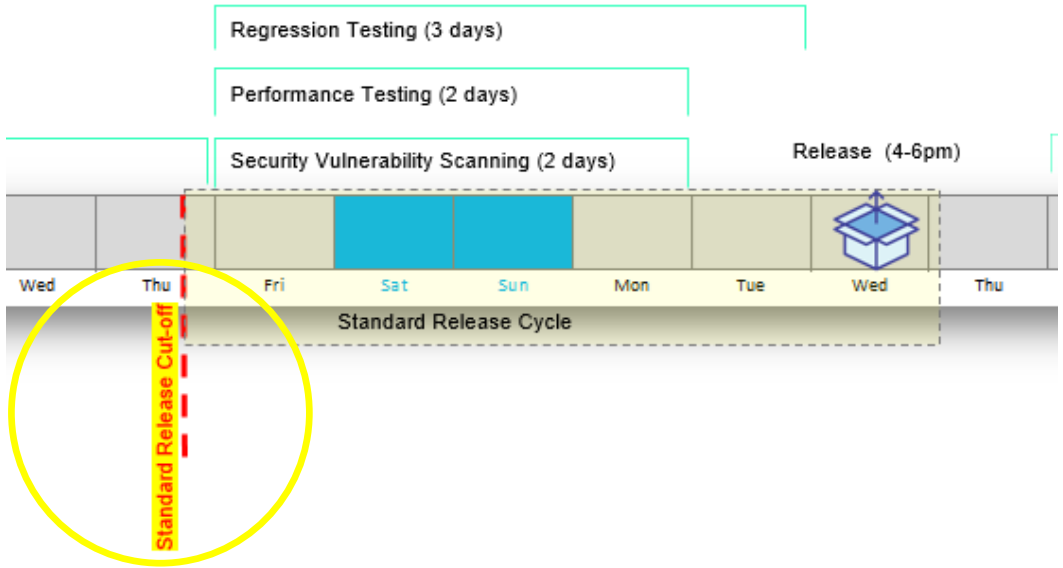
Standard Release – Details

Release cut-off date

+ Thursday before the release – 6 days before
+ It is an official start date of the release process
+ A date, on which the list of features that are fully developed, tested will be confirmed

Pre-requisites

+ Fully developed, tested list of features (individual user story is only allowed if they are meant for any open issues, tech debts) available in INTG
+ User stories and Features in ADO should have state as “ready to accept”
+ Release notes in ADO should have release readiness checklist (please refer the details of checklist below)
+ Functional testing sign-off
+ PO testing sign-off – the feature should have met all the acceptance criteria
+ Demo completion



Release Day and Time

+ Every other Wednesdays
+ Between 4 and 6pm
+ No product downtime to the end users

INTG Environment Code Freeze

Once the release is cut off, the INT environment is locked – bug fix code change are only allowed until the release is done.

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Standard Release – P&P Communication

Week	Sunday	Monday	Tuesday	Wednesday	Thursday	Friday	Saturday
Week 1 and 3		• INTG available for Functional testing	• INTG available for Functional testing	• *Sprint close* • PO tags completed features in ADO for targeted release date • INTG available for Functional testing	• *SM & Engg complete feature readiness checklist* • *PO drafts release notes* • ***Deadline for code changes deployed to INTG*** • ***INTG freeze @ 5pm CT***	• VP feature signoff • CTPO informs Clinical Training Lead of targeted feature delivery with pre-release notes (email) • **Initiate INTG regression testing**	
Week 2 and 4		• Clinical Training Lead to clarify any questions regarding pre-release notes with CTPO and associated TPO(s) • Clinical Training Lead to update relevant materials • **INTG regression testing**	• **INTG regression testing** • QA provides COB regression testing results • VP testing signoff (Go/No Go)	**Biweekly Release** • Prod release (4-6p CST) • End user validation (6p CST) • CTPO confirms successfully released features with Clinical Training Lead (email)	• ITSE hosts 7-9am CST post-release war room call • Clinical Training Lead disseminates release communication to end users • **INTG unfreeze @ 12pm CT**	• INTG available for Functional testing	

Stakeholder Engagement

- Release communications are sent directly to **Clinical Training Lead** via **CTPO**
- **Clinical Training Lead** is liaison responsible for informing customers (business stakeholders) and end users of release items, and is responsible for updating relevant materials
- If **Clinical Training Lead** has questions regarding pre-release notes, Clinical Training Lead should coordinate with **CTPO** and **TPO(s)** to clarify any outstanding details
- On Release Day ONLY, **CBPO** and **Clinical Training Lead** to contact **CTPO** directly if there are any issues
- End User Validation – RTE (future), CTPO (present) to reach out to designated end users for validation (Approved list of names required from Ops)

PRE-Release Note Details

- Release date and time
- Business value statement(s) – *Features should be translated into a statement that makes sense for the end user*
- Technical Product Owner – *For contact purposes should Clinical Training Lead need to better understand the update or require supporting screenshots, etc*

POST-Release Note Details

- Release date and time
- Business value statement(s) – *Features should be translated into a statement that makes sense for the end user*

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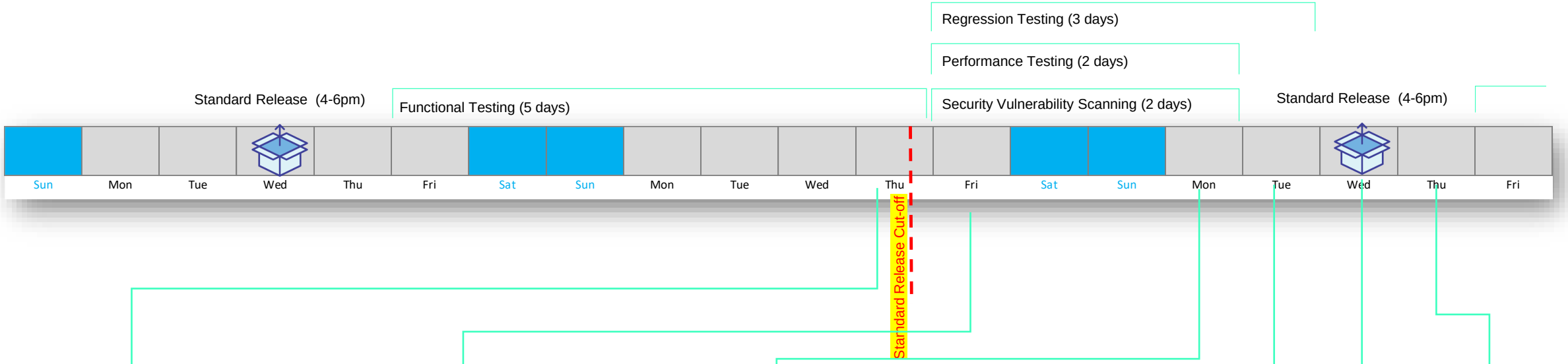
Standard Release – P&P Communication Timeline



VP feature signoff

- ***CTPO*** shares release scope, summary of all features & user stories, value, release level test plan and other highlights for their signoff

Pre-Release Notes

- ***CTPO*** informs *Clinical Training Lead* of targeted feature & user stories delivery
- Standard Release – 3 days in advance (Friday)
- Emergency Release – same day

- Clinical Training Lead to clarify any questions regarding pre-release notes with CTPO and associated TPO(s)
- Clinical Training Lead to update relevant materials

SLT Testing Sign-Off (Go / No Go)

Post-Release Alert

- CTPO confirms successfully released features with Clinical Training Lead (email)

- Clinical Training Lead disseminates release communication to end users

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Standard Release – Testing Procedure

Regression Testing

+ Performed by Team Lumos
+ 3 days – Friday, Monday and Tuesday before the release
+ Functional and non-functional tests (NFT) to ensure new and existing features still perform as expected after the new change
+ INTG environment
+ INTG code freeze
+ Functional testing sign-off
+ PO testing sign-off – the feature should have met all the acceptance criteria
+ Demo completion
+ Fully automated testing is the goal

On Demand

Performance Testing

+ Performed by Team NFT (Navin Rai's team)
+ *API only testing and on-demand due to environment constraint*
+ Plan in place to make it mandatory and routine
+ 2 days – Friday and Monday before the release
+ INTG environment (for now)
+ INTG code freeze
+ Functional testing sign-off
+ Results – actual against targets

Future

UAT Testing

+ Currently it is performed in PROD after the release aka MD validation

Future Process

+ 1 day, Monday before release
+ Ideal scenario is to perform UAT in UAT environment before the release
+ UAT environment is being built – ETA 3/31
+ Functional testing signoff
+ PO signoff from INTG
+ Demo completion in INTG
+ 1st run of regression testing completion (just a high level sanity check)

Security Scanning/Testing

This is only for future

+ 2 days, Friday and Monday before the release
+ No security scanning for the Q1 - this is just a plan for future start
+ Automated cloud security
+ Web application and API vulnerability scanning
+ Continuous penetration testing
+ Network monitoring
+ Environment - INTG
+ Pre-requisites are Unit tested code and INTG code freeze

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Standard Release – SLT Signoff

- SLT signoff is required to release any features into Prod - this is in place due to high visibility and avoid any potential break down in PROD
- Tuesday before the release
- SLT gets the release details once the release is cut-off, this is to share more details about the release level testing and get their sign-off
- After 1st run of regression testing, a sign-off approval request will be sent to SLT (Raj Sharda and Priyanka) with
  - Release scope (list of features)
  - Value details,
  - Details of functional testing signoff,
  - Details of PO sign off,
  - Details of demo completion,
  - Plan for regression testing, performance testing, security scanning

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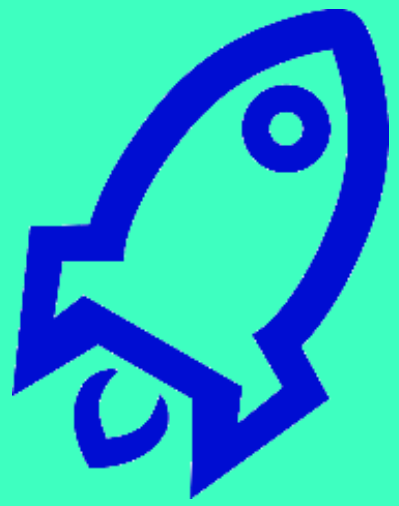
Standard Release – Calendar

Confluence Page:

[UCX Release Calendar - 2024](#)

Release Month	Release Name	Pre-Requisite		Release Readiness						Release Date
		Function Testing			Performance Testing		Regression Testing			
		FT Start	FT End	Release Cutoff	PT Start	PT End	RT Start	RT End	SLT SignOff	
		Fri	Thu	Thu	Fri	Mon	Fri	Tue	Mon	Wed
Jan	Beta	19-Jan	25-Jan	25-Jan	26-Jan	29-Jan	26-Jan	30-Jan	29-Jan	31-Jan
Feb	Alpha	2-Feb	8-Feb	8-Feb	9-Feb	12-Feb	9-Feb	13-Feb	12-Feb	14-Feb
Feb	Beta	16-Feb	22-Feb	22-Feb	23-Feb	26-Feb	23-Feb	27-Feb	26-Feb	28-Feb
Mar	Alpha	1-Mar	7-Mar	7-Mar	8-Mar	11-Mar	8-Mar	12-Mar	11-Mar	13-Mar
Mar	Beta	15-Mar	21-Mar	21-Mar	22-Mar	25-Mar	22-Mar	26-Mar	25-Mar	27-Mar
Apr	Alpha	29-Mar	4-Apr	4-Apr	5-Apr	8-Apr	5-Apr	9-Apr	8-Apr	10-Apr
Apr	Beta	12-Apr	18-Apr	18-Apr	19-Apr	22-Apr	19-Apr	23-Apr	22-Apr	24-Apr
May	Alpha	26-Apr	2-May	2-May	3-May	6-May	3-May	7-May	6-May	8-May
May	Beta	10-May	16-May	16-May	17-May	20-May	17-May	21-May	20-May	22-May
Jun	Alpha	24-May	30-May	30-May	31-May	3-Jun	31-May	4-Jun	3-Jun	5-Jun
Jun	Beta	7-Jun	13-Jun	13-Jun	14-Jun	17-Jun	14-Jun	18-Jun	17-Jun	19-Jun
Jul	Alpha	21-Jun	27-Jun	27-Jun	28-Jun	1-Jul	28-Jun	2-Jul	1-Jul	3-Jul
Jul	Beta	5-Jul	11-Jul	11-Jul	12-Jul	15-Jul	12-Jul	16-Jul	15-Jul	17-Jul
Jul	Gamma	19-Jul	25-Jul	25-Jul	26-Jul	29-Jul	26-Jul	30-Jul	29-Jul	31-Jul
Aug	Alpha	2-Aug	8-Aug	8-Aug	9-Aug	12-Aug	9-Aug	13-Aug	12-Aug	14-Aug
Aug	Beta	16-Aug	22-Aug	22-Aug	23-Aug	26-Aug	23-Aug	27-Aug	26-Aug	28-Aug
Sep	Alpha	30-Aug	5-Sep	5-Sep	6-Sep	9-Sep	6-Sep	10-Sep	9-Sep	11-Sep
Sep	Beta	13-Sep	19-Sep	19-Sep	20-Sep	23-Sep	20-Sep	24-Sep	23-Sep	25-Sep
Oct	Alpha	27-Sep	3-Oct	3-Oct	4-Oct	7-Oct	4-Oct	8-Oct	7-Oct	9-Oct
Oct	Beta	11-Oct	17-Oct	17-Oct	18-Oct	21-Oct	18-Oct	22-Oct	21-Oct	23-Oct
Nov	Alpha	25-Oct	31-Oct	31-Oct	1-Nov	4-Nov	1-Nov	5-Nov	4-Nov	6-Nov
Nov	Beta	8-Nov	14-Nov	14-Nov	15-Nov	18-Nov	15-Nov	19-Nov	18-Nov	20-Nov
Dec	Alpha	22-Nov	28-Nov	28-Nov	29-Nov	2-Dec	29-Nov	3-Dec	2-Dec	4-Dec
Dec	Beta	6-Dec	12-Dec	12-Dec	13-Dec	16-Dec	13-Dec	17-Dec	16-Dec	18-Dec

Emergency Release



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Emergency Release

+ Production hot fixes
+ Faster turnaround for resiliency
+ Checks and balance and gates are applicable
+ IT Service Excellence Approval (will find out who is the approver from Matt Lust)
+ Zero downtime

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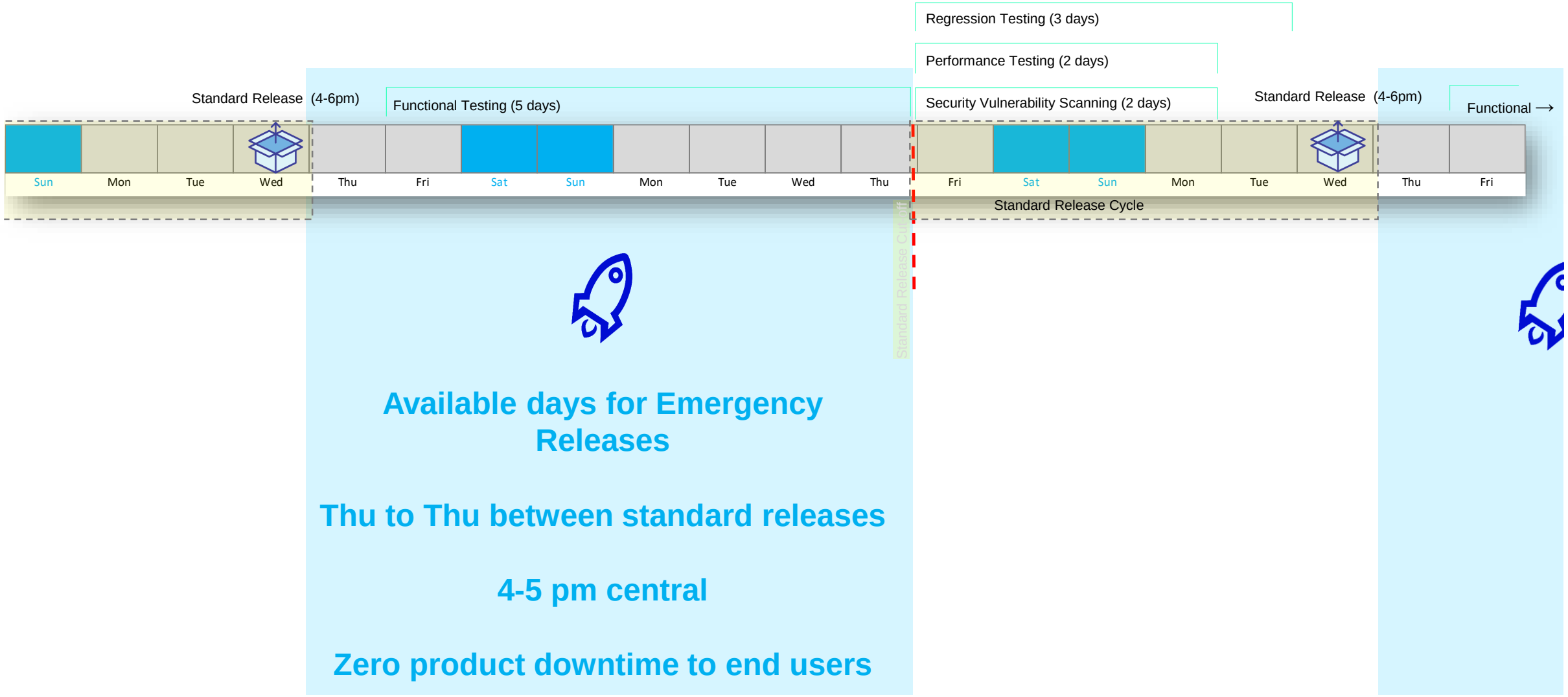
Emergency Release – Workflow Overview



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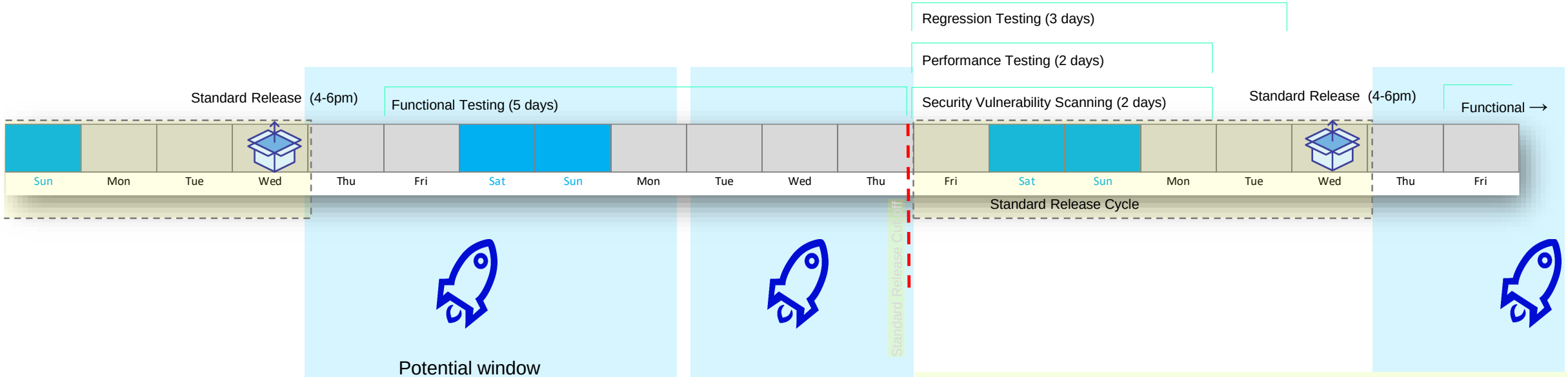
Emergency Release – Details



Potential window for post release issues and other production hot fixes

Potential window for production hot fixes

Release cut-off date & Time

+ Same day noon

Release Day and Time

+ Same day
+ From 4 CT
+ No product downtime to the end users

Communication

+ Communications will be disseminated same day
+ Assumes only 1 change that is business critical (ex: major prod degradation event)
+ Assumes ITSE will handle via standard ITSE outage event communication path

Pre-requisites

+ Justification, due diligence, root cause analysis are required for approval
+ CTPO procures pre-approval from IT SM (Matt Lust) and Business (Mike Bieker)
+ Issues are fixed, tested and available in INTG
+ Should have a separate release branch in ADO for code migration
+ User stories (Features) in ADO state should be “ready to accept”
+ Release notes in ADO should have release readiness checklist (please refer the details of checklist below)
+ Functional testing sign-off
+ PO testing sign-off *(Is Mike Bieker / MD sign-off required for the fix)*
+ Demo completion (based on scope)
+ Approvals – SLT (Raj Sharda, Priyanka)

Emergency Release – SLT Signoff

- Engineering lead procures pre-approval from IT SM (Matt Lust)
- CTPO procures pre-approval from Business (Mike Bieker)
- SLT (Raj Sharda, Priyanka) signoff is required to release any emergency fixes into Prod
- Same day approval request
- Once a thorough function and regression testing is done, a sign-off approval request will be sent to SLT by CTPO with
  - Issue details with root cause
  - Fix details
  - Details of functional testing signoff
  - Details of PO sign off
  - Details of demo completion *(based on the scope)*
  - Details of regression testing *(tailored for the fixes)*
  - Details of performance testing *(based on the scope)*
  - Details of security scanning *(future)*

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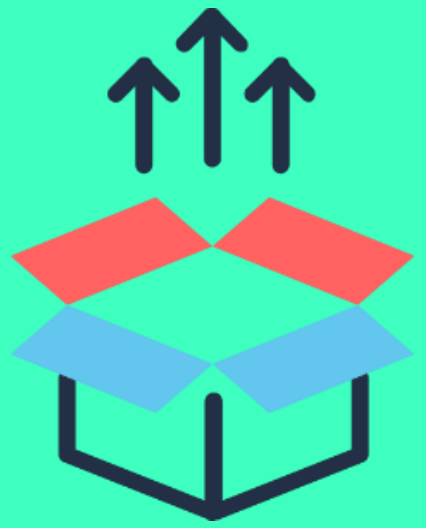
Special Release



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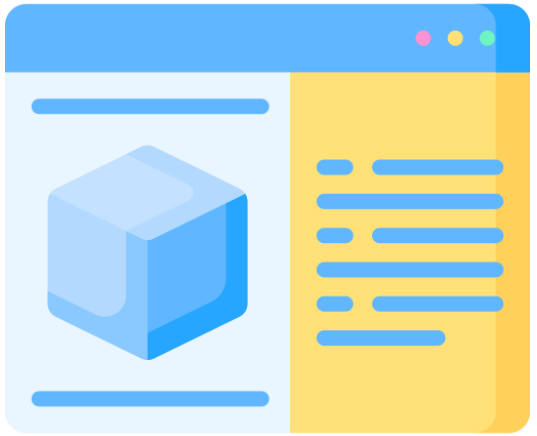
Special Release

+ For any specific date specific
+ Current environment limitation does not support this
+ Once additional environments are established, this will be instituted

+ **FUTURE**



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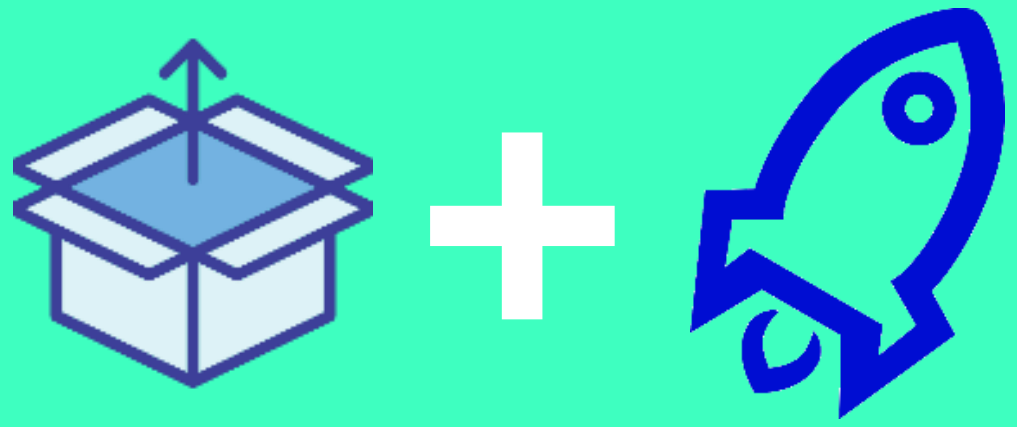
Other Details



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Release Artifacts & Owners

+ Regression Test Results – Team Lumos
+ Performance Test Results – Team Navin Rai
+ Security Test Results – Team Navin Rai (future)
+ Release Roster – Engineering Leads
+ Deployment Guide – Engineering Leads
+ Release communication – CTPO
+ Issue Tracker - CTPO

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Pre-Release Activities

S. No	List of Activities	Responsibility	Scheduled Release	Emergency Release	Special Release
1	Release Readiness Sync Up (Thu, Fri, Mon, Tue & Wed before release)	SM (facilitation) Dev, QA, POs, SMEs, Leads	Yes	Yes	NA
2	Review potential risks and mitigation plans	Dev Team	Yes	Yes	Yes
3	Review dependencies across UCX teams and also with XPG, Pathway, IO, eP & ePA teams	Dev Team, POs	Yes	Yes	Yes
4	Send feature list for SLT signoff	CTPO	Yes	Yes	Yes
5	Send Pre-Release Notes to Clinical Training Lead	CTPO	Yes	Yes	Yes
6	Deployment review for all ADO User Story (Automated and Manual Task) Code consistency review for all ADO User Story (Across Environments, Branching)	Engineering	Yes	Yes	Yes
7	Deploy list of features that are assigned to the release at least by the Thursday (cut-off date) before the release	Dev Team	Yes	Yes	Yes
8	Receive Leadership Signoff	CTPO / Engineering	Yes	Yes	Yes
9	Decide Release GO/NO-GO	Dev, QA, POs, CTPO	Yes	Yes	Yes

Future

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Release Checklist

S. No	List of Activities	Responsibility	Scheduled Release	Emergency Release	Special Release
1	Ensuring all ADO User Story tickets are on Ready state by the Cutoff date before release (Thursday before the release – 6 days before)	Dev team, SM & PO	Yes	Yes	Yes
2	Functional Testing signoff	Dev Team	Yes	Yes	Yes
3	PO testing signoff (INTG)	POs	Yes	Yes	Yes
4	Regression Testing signoff (Includes E2E Integration Testing)	Engineering (Team Lumos)	Yes	Yes	Yes
5	Keeping Rollback Plan / Release Notes in ADO ready	Dev Team	Yes	Yes	Yes
6	Release Roster	Engineering Leads, POs	Yes	Yes	Yes
7	Release deployment guide	Dev Team, POs	Yes	Yes	Yes
8	Post deployment Sanity Testing Plan	Engineering (Team Lumos)	Yes	Yes	Yes
9	Post deployment MD validation plan	CTPO	Yes	Based on the scope	Yes
10	Post release checks, monitoring & support plan	Engineering Leads	Yes	Yes	Yes
11	Pre-Release notes communication	CTPO	Yes	Yes	Yes
12	Release Execution Webex Setup	Engineering	Yes	Yes	Yes
13	Post Release War Room Setup	ITSE	Yes	Based on the release	Yes
14	Post Release Issue Tracker readiness	CTPO	Yes	Yes	Yes

Future

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Release Execution

+ **Standard Release:** Every other Wednesday from 4 to 6 pm central
+ **Emergency Release:** Thursday to Thursday between standard releases from 4 to 5 pm central

+ People from UCX, supporting teams listed in the ***Release Roster*** are expected to be available on the release call
+ Code deployment follows ***Deployment Guide***
+ Post deployment Sanity Testing will be performed by QA (Team Lumos)
+ Post deployment MD validation *(based on the scope)*

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Post Release Activities

+ Post release checks and exception monitoring
+ Post release notes communication
+ War Room support in the next day morning
+ Issue log, triaging, quick fixes

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APPENDIX

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UCX Environment Migration Path

- Three environments (1) Dev, (2) INTG & (3) PROD
- INTG is used for several testing needs
- Limited Environment
- New environments build (UAT & LOAD) in progress

DEV

Functional
Regression
PO Acceptance
Performance
Demo

UAT
Training
Live Use

EVERNORTH℠
Internal Information

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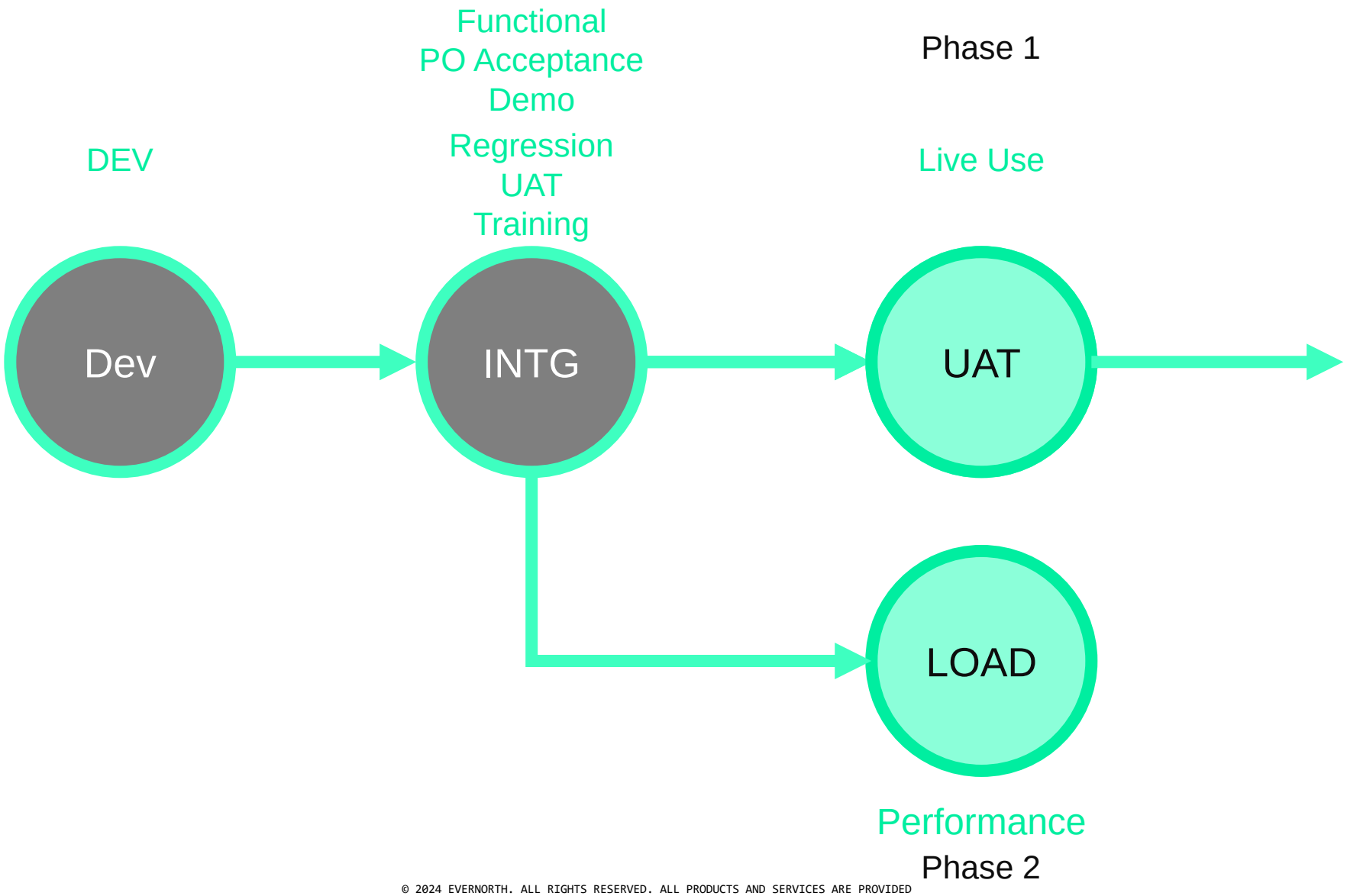
Environment Overview (UCX) – TO BE



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THANK YOU

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